

Transactional Analysis and Coaching

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INTRODUCTION

Transactional Analysis (TA) is known for its philosophy about how people can relate to themselves, others and the world, a philosophy colloquially referred to as 'I'm OK, you're OK'. This apparently simple statement combines an awareness of being in the world with others as independent but connected human beings ('I am, you are') with a belief in a positive aspiration to trust and respect each other and ourselves (Sills, 2007). Building on this, TA presents a theory of human development and communication and a meta-language or meta-perspective that allows a critique of various models, including TA itself.

The aim in this chapter is to describe how TA can inform coaching practice through providing a valuable thinking framework for the coach and by offering an accessible language to be shared with clients for greater understanding of the motivations, interactions and outcomes explored or experienced in the coaching conversation.

Eric Berne, the originator of TA, developed a system that is available to clients through an easily understood language; he was opposed to the elitism and obscuring terminology of the psychoanalytic profession (Stewart, 1992). As a psychiatrist and psychoanalyst in the USA during the 1950s and 1960s he observed the behaviour of clients towards himself and other people, in everyday life and in therapeutic groups. According to Berne, intentions, beliefs and early decisions could be inferred from the observations (by the client and/or the group as well as by the therapist) and checked out, thus presenting opportunities for change. Berne also

developed a systemic theory of organizations (Berne, 1963) which takes account of organizational culture, leadership, and the dynamics between these and the individuals and groups within organizations.

True to its colloquial tradition, TA has three straightforward key principles that derive from its value base.

- Everyone is OK (I'm OK, you're OK and they're OK) – belief in the worth and dignity of all people, mutual- and self-respect.
- Everyone can think – and therefore find solutions to solve problems.
- Anyone can change – their behaviour, thinking or feeling (if and when they so choose).

These principles form the base of open communication and a contractual process which is essential to TA practice. Its theoretical ground includes understanding causes, working from an ethical, values-based position and enabling behavioural change. It is also a very practical approach, presenting people with the opportunity to change while respecting their decision about how and when they want to do so.

Since Berne, TA has developed in both theory and practice. It is now widely used in organizational consultancy, team development and education, as well as being a particular approach in psychotherapy and counselling. The creative locus has moved from the USA to Europe, and current writing shows the breadth of outlook within the TA community, embracing psychodynamic, humanistic, cognitive-behavioural perspectives and positive psychology (Allen, 1997; Summers and Tudor, 2000; Sills & Hargaden, 2002).

PROMOTING AUTONOMY – THE AIM OF TA COACHING

The overall goal of TA-based work is change and autonomy, described by Berne (1964) as an awareness (of self and others), spontaneity in relationships, and the capacity for intimacy. Autonomy is variously clarified as cure, or as liberation, self-determination, independence and interdependence. The autonomous person makes his or her own decisions, thinks independently, knows how to avoid psychological games and *scripty* behaviours and is able to express an authentic self and to be fully available to others.

TA 'tools' – concepts, models, metaphors and diagrams – aim to promote autonomy by encouraging people to update old strategies or acquire new ones for interacting, problem solving and achieving goals. People recognize, relate to and integrate the models for themselves. These offer everyone a means to conceptualize their lived experience – of conflict, empathy, inspiration, emotion. Through the coherence of the models and the connections they make with them, individuals are able to make sense of their experience in new ways. Both coach and coachee can recognize their own patterns of thought, feeling and behaviour and bring into the coaching space how these affect the work they are doing together and how they might illuminate personal and professional dilemmas. The coach becomes an instrument in the work as well as an enabler.

THEORY AND PROCESS IN WORKING WITH A TA APPROACH TO COACHING

Contracting is at the heart of the approach. The TA-literate coach will be aware of the multiple contracts involved in any coaching relationship and sets out at the start to keep these as clear as possible – and to check the contract whenever anything seems to go awry. The first step is always to clarify what the contract is. Contracting happens at several levels.

- First is the administrative (Berne, 1966) or procedural (Hay, 2007) level – concerning *what* the coach and client will do together – how often? face-to-face or by phone? agenda and purpose? who pays and how much? how many sessions? for how long each time?
- This is supported by the professional (Berne, 1966) or implied level – how will these two (or more) people work together, how will they relate, what competencies and experience do they each bring, how will they establish trust and purpose?
- ‘Beneath’ these lies the psychological level of the contract, which is where the outcomes are determined (Berne, 1966). This concerns the ‘messages’ which we unconsciously send to others about our beliefs and how we ‘really’ see the coaching process. Will we aim to get the coach ‘on our side’ against the boss or organization? Will we hold onto our unconscious belief that nothing will change? Are we out to prove that ‘coaching won’t work for me’? All these beliefs might be held, entirely or partially out of awareness, by the client, by the coach (am I up to this?), or by a third party (he’s not right for the job but we’ll try coaching and that won’t work so we’ll get rid of him). For the coaching to be successful this ‘secret’ or hidden level needs to be addressed – perhaps by asking ‘what concerns do you have about coaching?’; how will I know if this isn’t working for you?; if we have a problem how will we deal with or recover from that?’ These, and similar questions, help to bring any potential difficulties into the open, as does clarity about the administrative and professional levels.

Time spent on good contracting is never wasted, although it can be time consuming. The aim of all involved parties knowing what they are here to do, trusting each other to do it, and working towards real, testable outcomes establishes the ground for effective coaching. Even though the psychological level of the contract may be positive from the start it still needs to be brought into awareness.

Not only is contracting multi-level, it is also multifaceted. English (1975) first described the three-cornered contract, between practitioner, client and organization (see Figure 12.1).

Often there are other parties to the contract. An individual client may have implied contracts with a manager, HR, colleagues; the coach may have contracts with associates or the partnership that employs them; the organization may be committed to coaching for everyone, and so on (see Figure 12.2).

Awareness of all these influencing relationships, and the potential impact on the contract between coach and client, even drawing them out visually, is a great tool at the start of a coaching relationship. The equilateral triangle represents a situation where all expectations and responsibilities are clear. If the triangle becomes distorted, so that some parties are psychologically closer and others more distant (Micholt, 1992), the coach can ask ‘what do we need to do to get the contract back to a healthy place?’ A useful question to ask when training new coaches and in coach supervision is ‘what is the contract?’ Often coaches reply that they didn’t have

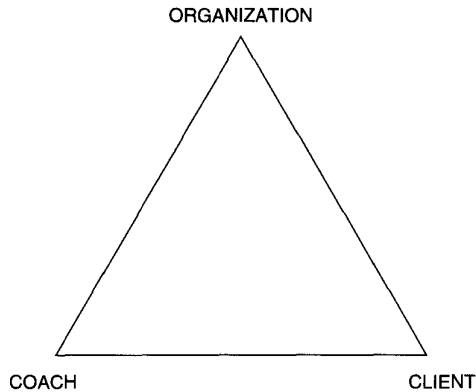


Figure 12.1 Three-cornered contract.

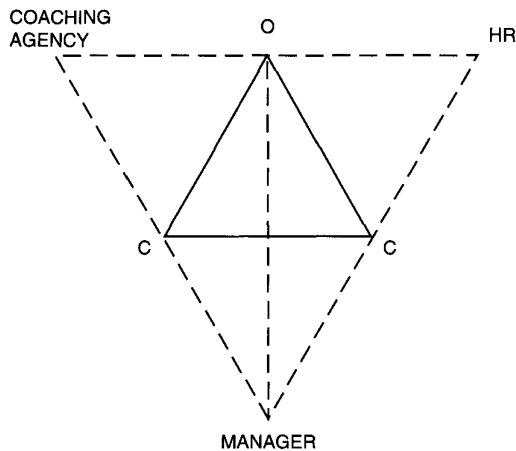


Figure 12.2 Multiple contracts.

a satisfactory three-way meeting before starting the work. The question generally causes recognition of what is going wrong – and how it can be put right.

Clear contracting implies an equal, OK–OK connection between coach and client. This is fundamental to a TA approach, and also a good definition of coaching. The 'OK' model indicates an 'I'm OK, you're OK' relationship as between two people; however, Berne's original writing (1962) suggests 'real' OK-ness involves an attitude to everyone – '3-D OK-ness', as Davidson (2007) described it – 'I'm OK, you're OK and they're OK'. Maintaining this OK

frame can be a challenge – and a quick way to check that we are ‘on track’ in problem solving. People (and thus organizations) sometimes behave in not-OK ways. When this happens it needs to be addressed. But the OK-ness model is also about attitude – how do we each relate? We have a useful intervention in asking – how will we get back to an OK place?

Having made a clear contract and established and modelled an OK relationship, there are some concepts that TA coaches will have in mind while listening to and working with clients.

Working with ego states

The most central concept of TA is ego states, also known as Parent, Adult and Child (PAC). The three ego states (more accurately, sets of ego states) comprise the structure of our personality, and their content is unique to each of us. We all began to develop them when we were very small and continue to update them throughout our lives as we gain new information. The subjective aspect of our experience, and our self-actualization, becomes our Child set of ego states; our probability estimating and objectivity forms our Adult set; and our relationship to others, and our imitation and modelling of them, becomes our Parent set of ego states, which may include things derived from many different people around us (see Figure 12.3).

Just as there are these three categories of ‘content’, so there are three corresponding categories of functioning – *structural* ego states are ‘what is there’; *functional* ego states are how

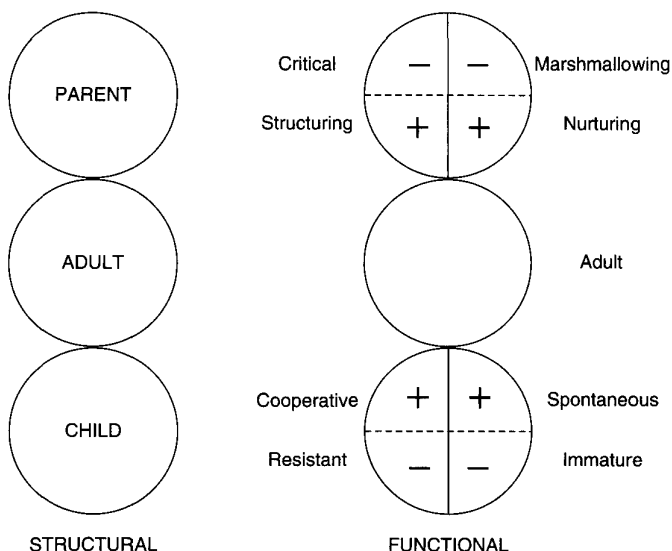


Figure 12.3 Ego-state diagrams.

we use that. How we act in relation to others, our interactions and communication can be described as modes of behaviour and can be positive or negative – the latter may be the result of lack of learning or of awareness of options or strategies. So, we might positively structure or negatively criticize, supportively nurture or insincerely ‘marshmallow’, account for all factors, cooperate with others or resist them, be creative and spontaneous or childishly immature. The aim is to respond appropriately from a positive mode (Temple, 2004).

Alert coaches will be constantly mapping the flow of energy between ego states through use of language, voice tone or body language – and checking out hunches. They might choose to share thinking with the client (I have a sense that someone in your head is telling you that), or ask a question (is that a real belief?) to maintain a present-centred dialogue. They might teach the basic PAC model to a client, or use it to reflect on the session afterwards and raise their own awareness of what happened in any discordant moments, and consciously choose a healthier ego state next time.

It has to be said that the ego-states concept, although probably the best known, is sometimes the least well understood. For instance there is a belief that people should use adult functioning whenever possible. However, real optimal behaviour means using a balance of the five positive ego-states modes, accounting for appropriateness to the situation.

Transactions, games and script

The next group of concepts (transactions, games and script) can be used to describe what happens between the coach and client. Transactional analysis explores our observable interactions and the modes of behaviour that we derive from our ego states. By monitoring and diagnosing transactions between people we have a great resource to identify how we see ourselves and others, how they might see us, how we ‘block’ or sabotage our intentions and how we might transact differently to gain a different result.

One of the ways of doing this – and with perhaps the most useful model in the process of TA coaching – is to become aware of the roles of Persecutor, Rescuer and Victim in the drama triangle (see Figure 12.4). This model (from Karpman, 1968) is an elegant way of mapping the positions we take in psychological game playing. Games are ineffective interactions that follow old, familiar patterns and lead to negative outcomes (Berne, 1964). We become involved in games when we feel in need of strokes (recognition) and play from our preferred position of helplessness (V), over-helpfulness (R) or harassment (P); as we play out our personal aspect of transference and/or countertransference in the relationship, transacting in old familiar ways as we ‘see’ others in particular roles. Coaches can learn their own triggers and somatic signals that tell them that they have been subtly invited to Rescue: ‘How can I help you solve this?’ Persecute: ‘I wish you’d get on with it’, or compete with the client for the Victim role: ‘I don’t know what to suggest’.

When coaches realize that they have been caught in this game (or the client does) they have several techniques for getting back to effective work. One option is to talk about it

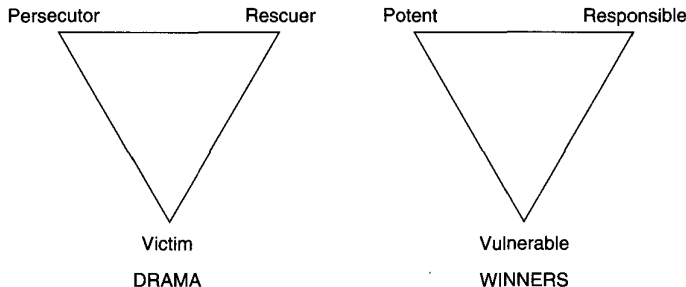


Figure 12.4 Drama and winners triangles.

(what happened there?) and use it as material rich in information that the client and coach can access. Another option is to think back to the contract and identify what behavioural changes might be needed and what changes in perception of self and others might accompany them. A third and incredibly freeing option is to switch to the winners triangle (Choy, 1990) and swap rescuing for responsiveness, persecution for potency and victim-hood for vulnerability.

The clue to moving from game playing to authenticity is to recognize the truth behind the game roles: people do have real problems for which they have not yet learned the strategies to solve; people are genuinely and appropriately concerned about others welfare and can offer support without taking over; and people can be assertive about what they can and cannot do without 'pushing' or blaming others (Napper & Newton, 2000).

Re-decision

Coach and client are engaged together in a co-creative process, rewriting, or re-deciding, part of the client's personal narrative. Every time we become involved in a game we reinforce early decisions about who we are and how OK we are. These decisions, along with the beliefs we have arrived at about how the world works, form our personal story or life script, our childhood meaning-making, which will include some parts that are limiting or even harmful. Every time we challenge these beliefs, recognize a game we play and decide to do something different, action OK–OK transactions, we write part of a healthier story for ourselves. We do this in relationship, not alone (Cornell, 1988; Summers & Tudor, 2000; Newton, 2006). This 're-storying' is done in partnership – coaches might also update their own script stories while paying attention to their client's.

As coaching nears its end the coach will be aware of the importance of contract completion and will check that there is sufficient time to fill any gaps, finishing positively (strokes), and allowing time for review, acknowledging achievements and sadness for a profound relationship coming to an end, as well as looking forward to new goals and pastures.

TA AND SOME OTHER TRADITIONS

A feature of the versatility of TA is the way it has both drawn on and connected to a number of other approaches during its history. It originally grew out of Eric Berne's learning as a psychoanalyst and his extensive reading of the British object relations school; the focus on the intra-psychic within TA is essentially psychodynamic. The structural ego-state model provides 'maps', in the Parent ego state revealing the introjected part-objects, and in the Child ego states denoting self-objects. One criticism of TA is that these diagrams can in themselves reify the theory and take away from the uniqueness of the individual as we look for theoretical patterns. When they are seen as the useful metaphors that they are, ego-states concepts make the intra-psychic more available for discussion and facilitate identification of patterns in the inter-psychic.

The 'humanistic' school is generally regarded as the natural home of TA, alongside person-centred and Gestalt approaches. These share a belief in the value of the individual and their potential for wholeness. Some differences appear when we look at the focus of the TA approach through contracting, for instance, and in confronting game playing and ultimatums by challenging or crossing the transaction. While TA provides a coherent theoretical framework for understanding individuals, groups and systems, Gestalt provides a valuable methodology 'borrowed' by TA. Three-chair work, for instance, can be used in TA coaching as well, to explore intra-psychic conversations between the Parent, Adult and Child ego states; or to investigate motivations to Persecute, Rescue or be a Victim.

The emphasis on life script as a key concept in TA makes an important link with Narrative and Constructivist approaches. Life script is not a once and for all decision but an ongoing process of telling and re-telling our personal stories, co-creating new narratives in the present to replace the unhelpful narratives of the past (Allen & Allen, 1997; Summers & Tudor, 2000; Newton, 2006).

There are also developing connections that TA is keen to explore. Emergent theory in TA (Allen, 2007; Barrow, 2007; Newton, 2007) focuses on health and thriving as something we can promote through applying well-tested ideas about healthy communication and relationships, together with knowledge gained from research into brain development (Gerhardt, 2004). TA can also draw on positive psychology, although the emphasis in 'positive psychology-transactional analysis' is different from traditional TA in that the latter is often pathology oriented. For instance, the traditional 'tombstone' question is designed to reveal limiting script beliefs, whereas the health-oriented 'write your own obituary' task reveals strengths that people may often not realize.

CONTEXTS FOR TA COACHING

The contexts in which a knowledge of TA can inform coaching are many: life coaching (enabling clients to understand how they 'block' themselves through ineffective strategies and

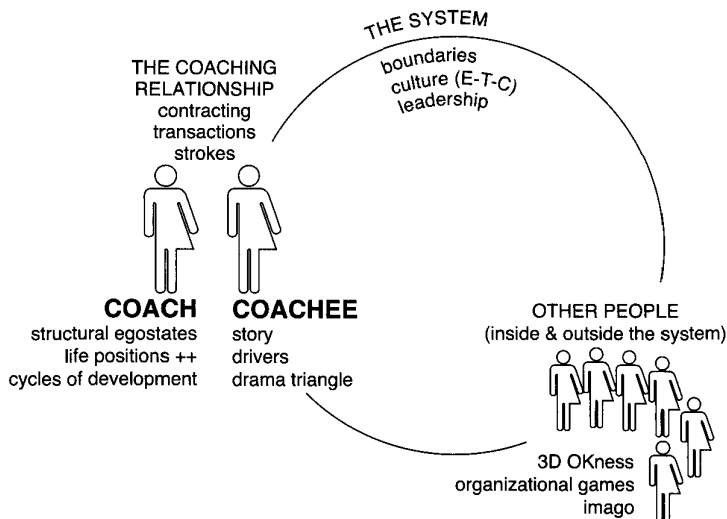


Figure 12.5 TA concepts in organizational coaching.

offering ways of changing these patterns); executive coaching (accounting for organizational culture and multiple relationships in a work context); team coaching (how different working styles benefit or inhibit a team); and parent coaching (a model of child development and strategies for change).

The diagram in Figure 12.5 shows the complexity of relationships involved when coaching and some of the TA concepts to be borne in mind by the coach in a coaching relationship, its context and related systems. Some of this can be shared with the client. The following stories describe, first, coaching with a team and their manager; and second, an example of career coaching in a cross-cultural context.

Coaching teams and managers in an organization

The first two case-studies are connected. A public sector organization shifting from a directive management style to a coaching approach to management asked external coaches to work with a team and the team manager.

A long-standing manager, Dave, had been referred for coaching as he showed signs of stress. He agreed with the new approach, yet found it difficult to engage in it with his team and was uncertain about his authority. The HR Director joined for a three-way meeting once Dave and the coach had explored the professional and psychological contract for working together. As a result there was agreement to provide coaching for Dave's team to enable them to get to grips

with the impact of organizational changes on their roles. The following illustrates how two coaches shared similar TA models with manager and team.

Management coaching

The coach working with Dave used the template of functional ego states; he found having a map in his mind helpful. The Parent ego state is concerned with being in charge and providing both structure and nurture. Clarke and Dawson (1998) suggest that this can be thought of as a highway with two clear ‘lanes’, the negotiable and the non-negotiable. This helped, for instance, to differentiate a manager using the (negotiable) coach approach, e.g. to provide the boundaries around a team member goal-setting for themselves, and providing (non-negotiable) direction, e.g. with health and safety compliance.

In addition to being in charge, the coach manager needs to take account of what is happening (Adult), co-operate when staff take charge of a piece of work, and be spontaneous and think outside the box (+ Child). This model proved extremely valuable to Dave, who shared it at a team coaching to explain his role and range of styles. Three months later, at the next three-way meeting, he reported feeling much less stressed; the stand-off style of conflict within the team lessened, communication increased, and attitudes to the senior leadership function within the organization became much more positive. Eventually, he reflected to his coach how she had modelled for him, without comment, these different ways of being in charge in their relationship.

Team coaching

The second coach spent time exploring with the team the psychological level of the contract, by telling and inviting stories about how things held in mind and not expressed can cause ongoing rumblings or even explosive conflicts – and how organizational change often triggered thoughts and feelings that could lead to tricky interactions. She followed this with interactive input on ‘OK-ness’ linked to the fight, flight, freeze instinctive responses (Figure 12.6), giving and inviting examples from the team.

The value of the positive OK–OK (flow) position was evident to the team. Also evident was the difficulty of holding this when someone else invited you to respond to their negative position – ‘I’m not OK and You’re not OK’ tries to get others to join in moaning; the ‘I’m not OK You are’ person goes looking for an ‘I’m OK and You’re not’ person to prove them right (and vice versa!). Ideas emerged among the team for how to work together better, which one member turned into posters for their offices.

The other part of the team coaching explored Schmid’s (2006) roles theory. A ‘role’ is a coherent system of attitudes, feelings, behaviour, perspectives on reality and the accompanying relationships. This suggests that personality is constructed through all the role relationships we have ever been in; these cluster into four arenas: Personal (e.g. sister, friend, school-kid);

— + I'm not OK You're OK FLIGHT Passenger	+ + I'm OK You're OK FLOW Participant
— — I'm not OK You're not OK FREEZE Prisoner	+ — I'm OK You're not OK FIGHT Protester

Figure 12.6 Life positions and flow.

Professional roles (areas of expertise such as planner, outreach, designer); and Organizational roles, including leader, manager, trade union representative, plus all sorts of major and minor ways of representing the organization's policies and practices both internally and externally (Schmid, 2006). The fourth arena, Community roles (e.g. neighbour, voluntary worker), was later added by Mohr (2006).

Each person made a personal chart for each arena; sharing these facilitated new appreciation of each other and helped everyone clarify their own and each other's current roles. The organizational arena proved fascinating for the team who had never before differentiated times when they and their manager represented the organization, regardless of professional expertise and opinion. What also became apparent for everyone was how miscommunication can happen and how one role area can contaminate or exclude another – when being a parent interferes with working arrangements and others' workloads, or taking work home impacts on family life. The team identified the need for 'contracting' so as to clarify boundaries and give everyone concerned a chance to say what is on their mind, prior to making decisions about what to do.

This work with the team was useful for Dave in clarifying that his role is primarily organizational, and his job is to carry and inspire his team with the organization's purpose and values, and enable them to maximize their own potential and contribute to the organization's whole.

Cross-cultural career coaching

The following case-study illustrates both an approach to career change and overtly cross-cultural work. Using script as an internal reference point the coach was able to work sensitively with difference while acknowledging the recognition and shared values between coach and client that formed a sound basis for working together.

Marsha, a black woman, made a private approach to a coach, a white woman, about her career. She felt in a rut in a private sector managerial post but did not know what she wanted to do instead. Surfacing the psychological level of the contract proved important – why had she chosen this person as a coach? What impact might their different cultures and ethnicities make? It turned out that Marsha admired the coach's entrepreneurship in setting up a coaching business, and that she wasn't sure whether race and cultural differences would help or hinder; however there was agreement that these could be raised by either. Without explaining TA ideas of script the coach asked Marsha to tell her what had been her favourite story around the ages of five to seven. The intention was multiple: to find if there were any kernels of unrealized dreams that might contribute to career decisions, to check on levels of optimism and idealism, and to invite the resources of creativity, intuition and imagination of the Child ego state via positive memories.

The traditional folk story that Marsha told involved a little girl going on a long journey that was very hard work, meeting up with a wicked witch and a wise woman along the way. Marsha had forgotten the purpose of the girl's journey and found it hard to imagine the ending. Rather than asking 'powerful questions', a TA approach considers whether to make the intention behind a query evident by expressing the thought behind the question. The coach wondered aloud about the parallels between the story and what Marsha had already shared about her current situation. Marsha's response was a 'light-bulb' moment of realization, which illuminated the possibility of stepping out of this frame of reference into 'a different story' – one that she made up in the present.

As the story-making frame seemed useful, Marsha agreed to make up lots of stories and look for others that appealed in films, books, and the media. The themes that emerged were: to use her hands in making things, being independent, and providing a service to black women – combining a positive psychology framework of 'the pleasurable, engaged and meaningful life' with TA ideas about life-script. Marsha decided that a portfolio career beginning with one day a week while reducing her well-paid employment time might be a fulfilling experiment. She set up a small business making greetings cards for the Afro-Caribbean community, volunteered as a mentor for women setting up their own businesses and gradually shifted to a three-day week, employing others to help make the cards. A critical moment occurred when the coach was able to say: 'being black is one of your unique strengths – it's OK to build on it!'

EVALUATION

The TA approach provides coaches with useful thinking frameworks. Coaching itself, like TA, uses the Adult ego state through direct questioning and by promoting autonomy, accountability and straight communication. By looking out for ego-state shifts, drama triangle roles, familiar patterns of transacting and unconscious script beliefs the TA-literate coach gains invaluable information to feed back to the client to facilitate getting 'unstuck' or understanding difficulties.

All this may lead the reader to think that TA as an approach is overly structured. Although this may appear true, in fact the TA coach holds the models and concepts in an internal, integrated framework that informs and enriches the use of self in the coaching relationship. The TA coach will be modelling a positive, respectful, attentive and optimistic attitude derived from the philosophy and principles of TA and will demonstrate all positive modes of behaviour as the ‘integrating Adult’ (Temple, 2004) maps the flow of transactions. The TA coach will show a readiness to change and willingness to be influenced by clients in their co-creative dialogue. They will be potent and present in the here-and-now.

Another characteristic feature of the TA coach is the ability to share important ideas with clients in a straightforward and comprehensible way. Familiarity with the models and experience of their value and impact creates a common language to enhance the coaching conversation and move to outcomes.

Limitations

At the same time a recurring challenge for TA is being seen as superficial or ‘too easy’; a continuing theme since Berne’s time – confusing a straightforward, clear-cut language with an unsophisticated approach (Stewart, 1992), or use of simple language with risk of reifying concepts into concrete ‘things’ instead of explicable metaphors. Many writers on psychotherapy traditionally used complex terms to describe phenomena which are in fact easily recognizable; Berne used language that is *simpler* than his ideas (Stewart, 1992). Basic to a TA approach is the belief that a problem being serious does not automatically mean solving it will be complex or difficult.

Some clients may be resistant to the overt use of TA, seeing it as simplistic and unappealing in its colloquialism, even threatening in its directness and candour. Some may be invested in unproductive behaviours which may indicate a ‘fixed’ frame of reference which is better worked through via a counselling or psychotherapy relationship. Using TA can unexpectedly bring out clients’ underlying needs, which may feel inappropriate in coaching, or not understood; the coach must be aware of the triggers and indicators for each client.

Coaches with some TA knowledge may struggle at first to apply it, and to introduce TA concepts without being directive. Those who want to add TA to their toolkit need to be willing to practice ‘talking TA’ (for instance in supervision), and above all to apply the learning to themselves before sharing it with clients.

And finally, a serious challenge for TA coaching is that in spite of having such riches available, TA has no clear methodology for coaching – or TA practitioners have not yet developed one.

Strengths of TA

TA can be most useful as an internal, analytic tool that works fast and accurately for an experienced coach; it can also be invaluable in creating a shared language with clients. This makes it

particularly helpful for coach supervision – the coach who never mentions a TA idea to clients can still find it a powerful means of self-supervision and reflection on practice as well as a basis for discussion with a supervisor (Hay, 2007; Newton & Napper, 2007).

Three key features underpin this usefulness: TA practice is based on observable evidence of patterns of behaviour, thinking and feeling; these link to internal dynamics that are significant for the client and/or the coach; attention to the contract keeps the focus on positive problem solving.

After 60 years, the work of Eric Berne continues to develop well into the present. Today, we have a very flexible system that can be used in many ways to enable people to empower themselves. Whatever is the main approach of the coach, TA-literacy will help to combine their own creativity with their selection of useful tools to provide a safe, structured space, offer support and encouragement, take account of multiple perspectives, work cooperatively with others, and, above all, enjoy!

FURTHER READING

- Napper, R., & Newton, T. (2000). *Tactics – transactional analysis concepts for all trainers, teachers and tutors + insight into collaborative learning strategies*. Ipswich: TA Resources. (This book illustrates a potential of TA to inform the adult learning process. It provides an introduction to the central TA theory for people without TA knowledge who are engaged in facilitating learning (such as coaches). It will be also useful for experienced transactional analysts to consider TA ideas in relation to design of learning strategies and interventions.)
- Stewart, I., & Joines, V. (1987). *TA today*. Nottingham: Lifespace Publishing. (This book provides a clear overview of currently accepted foundations of TA theory from a cognitive perspective in a counselling and psychotherapy context. There are learning activities threaded through the text which bring alive the psychological theory.)
- Hay, J. (1996). *Working it out at work*. Watford: Sherwood Publishing. (People who want a straightforward approach for understanding everyday difficulties find this a useful and very readable book to grapple with the dynamics of the workplace. It is aimed at those who do not want an academic perspective, but want to have a basic grasp of ideas in relation to change.)

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